MORNING BRIEFING — MONDAY 13 JULY 2026

Generated 07:00 BST (London) • Data collected 05:00–07:00 UTC / 06:00–08:00 BST, 13 July 2026 • Reference timezone: Europe/London (BST = UTC+1) • Covers: US session Friday 10 July, Asian session overnight/Monday 13 July, weekend news

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

US-Iran Gulf conflict escalates sharply over the weekend

Reuters / CNBC / Yahoo Finance • ~06:00 BST

The US struck Iran again on Saturday after Iranian attacks on shipping near the Strait of Hormuz; Iran retaliated against US positions across the Gulf, with reports of strikes reaching as far as Qatar and the UAE. Iran claims the Strait is closed to traffic; Washington disputes this, saying vessels continue to transit. Exact chronology of the preceding week (reports of an interim ceasefire collapsing) varies by source — treat with caution — but the direction, a serious re-escalation over the weekend, is well corroborated. This is the dominant driver of today's risk-off tone and the overnight oil spike.

Oil jumps 3-4% on Gulf escalation

TradingEconomics / Reuters • ~06:30 BST

Brent rose to roughly $78.50-79/bbl and WTI to ~$73.83/bbl in early Monday trade. Revives inflation risk just ahead of Tuesday's US CPI print and complicates the path for new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh, who testifies to Congress this week.

Kospi triggers 18th sell-side circuit breaker of 2026

Korea JoongAng Daily / Korea Times • ~05:00 BST

Kospi fell as much as 7% intraday as investors took profits in SK Hynix and Samsung Electronics on concerns the AI-memory rally has run too far, compounded by Gulf-war jitters. Raises questions about the durability of the AI/semiconductor trade that has powered much of 2026's equity gains, with read-through risk to Nasdaq and European chip names (ASML, Infineon, STMicro) at today's open.

SK Hynix's record $26.5bn Nasdaq debut, then a sharp Seoul reversal

Yahoo Finance / CNBC • Friday 10 July close

The largest-ever US share sale by a foreign company priced at $149, popped as much as 13% on its Friday debut (order book >7x covered) and helped lift Friday's S&P 500 and Nasdaq closes — before Monday's sharp reversal in Seoul-listed SK Hynix and Samsung shares. Illustrates how fast sentiment on AI/memory names is swinging session to session.

Vodafone and easyJet in the M&A spotlight

Reuters / company statements • Friday-weekend

Xavier Niel's Vega vehicle agreed to buy ~16.2% of Vodafone from Emirates Telecom (e&) for ~£4.4bn at 112.5p/share (Vodafone +13% Friday). easyJet's board is now backing Apollo Global Management's 715p/share offer over Castlelake's 690p bid, with a firm-offer deadline of 7 August under the UK Takeover Code. Two of the largest live UK corporate situations, both likely to stay volatile today.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

CONTRACT	LEVEL	EXPECTED MOVE	COLLECTION TIME
Euro Stoxx 50 (FESX)	n/a	**Expected lower, tracking Wall St futures & Asian weakness**	07:00 BST
DAX (FDAX)	n/a	**Expected lower, in line with ES50**	—
CAC 40 (FCE)	n/a	**Expected lower, in line with ES50**	—
FTSE 100 (Z)	n/a	**Expected lower, though heavier energy weighting is a partial offset given the oil spike**	—
US context — pre-market futures			
S&P 500 e-mini	n/a	**-0.58%**	~06:00 BST
Nasdaq-100 e-mini	n/a	**-1.37%**	~06:00 BST
Dow futures	n/a	**-229 pts / -0.43%**	~06:00 BST

> No reliable, date-specific print for European index futures levels could be confirmed this morning — search results were internally contradictory. Levels marked n/a; direction is inferred from the risk-off tone in Asia and US futures. Verify against a live Eurex/ICE quote before trading on this.

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (FRIDAY 10 JULY 2026)

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
Euro Stoxx 50	6,268	**-0.2% to -0.3%**
DAX	25,067.09	**-0.20%**
CAC 40	8,338.97	**+0.15%**
FTSE 100	10,497.29	**+0.24%**

Europe closed a turbulent week little changed/mixed on Friday as volatility receded on hopes of a diplomatic channel between Washington and Tehran, and oil eased back from its earlier-week spike. Weekly performance was still weak: Euro Stoxx 50 down ~2% and Stoxx 600 down ~1.8% for the week — before the weekend's fresh escalation.

5. US MARKETS — FRIDAY 10 JULY 2026 SESSION

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,575.39	**+31.75 pts / +0.42%**
Dow Jones Industrial Average	52,637.01	**+149.60 pts / +0.29%**
Nasdaq Composite	26,281.61	**+74.72 pts / +0.29%**

Tone: Mildly risk-on into the close, capping a choppy week with a winning finish.

Leading: Tech/semiconductors, powered by SK Hynix's Nasdaq debut (as much as +13% on its first day).

Lagging: n/a — no reliable sector-laggard breakdown found.

Key takeaway: Markets closed a volatile week higher on chip-stock strength and an at-the-time easing of Middle East oil fears, even as underlying Iran tensions remained unresolved into the weekend — tensions that then re-escalated sharply over Saturday and Sunday.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT/MONDAY 13 JULY 2026 SESSION

INDEX	LEVEL	CHANGE
Nikkei 225	68,130.25	**-427.48 pts / -0.62%**
Kospi	7,386.58 (at trading halt)	**As much as -7% intraday; 18th sell-side sidecar of 2026 triggered 10:34 local time**
Hang Seng	n/a — conflicting reports	One source +0.91% (~24,238), another shows a fall to ~23,497
Shanghai Composite / CSI 300	~3,968 (Shanghai Composite)	**CSI 300 -0.64%; Shanghai Composite ~-0.7%**

Clearly risk-off across the region, driven by two compounding factors: the weekend's sharp US-Iran/Gulf military escalation, and a profit-taking wave in Korean AI-memory chip names (SK Hynix, Samsung Electronics) spilling into regional sentiment. Nikkei Semiconductor sub-index -1.58%.

> Hang Seng direction is unconfirmed — two independent searches returned contradictory figures. Verify against a live quote before publishing further.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE	CONTEXT
Brent crude	$78.50-79.20/bbl	**+3.3% to +4.2%**	Gulf escalation risk premium re-priced in; still well below the ~$126 peak seen earlier in 2026's Iran-conflict episodes.
WTI crude	~$73.83/bbl	**+3.4%**	Same Gulf-escalation catalyst as Brent.
Gold (spot)	~$4,050/oz	**-1.5% to -1.7%**	Counterintuitive drop: a stronger dollar and rising yields (inflation/hike repricing from the oil spike) are outweighing safe-haven demand.
Natural gas (EU TTF)	~€50.10/MWh	**+2.2%**	European supply-security concerns tied to the Gulf shipping route.
Natural gas (US Henry Hub)	$2.94-3.05/ MMBtu	n/a for today (last available: Friday close)	—
Copper (LME)	$13,600-13,650/t	**+0.5%, near record highs**	Supply disruptions (Grasberg, Chile) and AI/clean-tech demand outweighing demand-destruction fears from the oil spike.

8. RATES & FX

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE
US 10Y Treasury yield	~4.59%	**+2bps (yields up = price down)**
German 10Y Bund yield	~3.10%	**+1 to +6bps (Friday baseline uncertain across sources)**
EUR/USD	1.1395-1.1403	**-0.1% to -0.2%**
GBP/USD	~1.3383	**-0.1%**
DXY	~101.0-101.1	**+0.1% to +0.2%, near highest since 8 July**

Treasuries sold off across the curve on the fresh Iran strikes; the 2-year yield hit its highest since February 2025 (4.23%). The Bund is extending a multi-week rise on growing ECB hike bets tied to oil-driven inflation risk. Dollar firm on safe-haven and rate-differential flows.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES

No confirmed EUR or USD corporate IG, high-yield, SSA or financials deals priced specifically on Friday 10 July — consistent with a typically quiet EUR primary Friday and the mid-July seasonal slowdown. Most recent notable activity, week of 6-10 July:

ISSUER	SIZE	MATURITY	COUPON/SPREAD	IPT-TO-PRICING
EU Commission (SSA) — priced Wed 8 Jul	€11bn dual-tranche	5Y (13 Oct 2031) + 20Y tap (12 Oct 2046)	5Y: 2.875% cpn / 2.947% yield; 20Y tap: 4.000% cpn / 4.018% yield	n/a
TenneT Germany (utilities, IG) — priced Tue 7 Jul	€3.5bn, 4 tranches	4y/8y/12y/20y	3.25% / 3.625% / 4.125% / 4.625%	n/a
Honda Motor (autos, IG) — priced ~Fri 3 Jul	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
IFC (SSA) — euro debut, early/mid Jul	n/a	7Y	n/a	n/a

EU 5Y book >€83bn (~13.8x covered); TenneT book >€21bn (>6x covered) — the largest-ever EU Green Bond-standard-aligned corporate green bond.

PIPELINE / EXPECTED THIS WEEK (W/C 13 JULY)

ISSUER	DETAIL
EU-Bonds (SSA)	Auction today, 13 July (competitive window 09:15-11:30 CET); part of plan to raise €80bn long-term EU-Bonds Jul-Dec 2026
France (OATs)	Mid-month auction expected 16 July: 3Y OAT 09/29, 5Y OAT 02/32, plus linkers, ~€9bn total
Netherlands (DSL)	Possible new 20Y launch and/or tap ~14 or 28 July, €6-7bn combined — timing uncertain
Corporate/financials EUR	No specific mandates identified — supply likely front-loaded into the prior week ahead of the summer lull
Covered bonds	H1 2026 pace strong (€121.7bn, +21.2% y/y); no specific w/c 13 July mandates found
EUR CLOs	Active recent pipeline (4 new issues, 3 refi, 2 resets, ~€3.5bn priced prior week); AAA new-issue spreads ~120bps area

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL	DIRECTION
iTraxx Europe Main (5Y)	n/a	No 2026 print found
iTraxx Europe Crossover (5Y)	~315-320bps (stale, mid-May 2026)	STALE
CDX North America IG (5Y)	~96bps (stale, 12 June 2026)	STALE
Euro corporate IG (iBoxx/ICE BofA)	No exact OAS print (source blocked)	DIRECTIONALLY NEAR HISTORIC TIGHTS

> Exact intraday 13 July levels for iTraxx Main, Crossover and CDX IG could not be obtained via web search (terminal-level real-time CDS data not accessible). Directional context: broadly range-bound-to-tighter year-to-date with intermittent widening on tariff/geopolitical headlines. Today's Gulf escalation is a headline risk for a widening move — verify against a Bloomberg/Markit terminal before publishing exact levels.

COMMENTARY

Primary issuance was clearly front-loaded into the first half of July — TenneT's record green bond and the EU's €11bn syndication both cleared multiple-times-oversubscribed books on 7-8 July — but the window looks to be closing into the seasonal mid-July/August lull, with no fresh EUR corporate or financials mandates identified for this week. Investor appetite remains robust where deals do price, reflecting spreads sitting near multi-year tights, though flow skewed toward industrials/utilities and autos this cycle, with transport and pure energy issuers notably absent. The weekend's Gulf escalation is the key swing factor for the days ahead: a sustained oil/rates shock would likely widen spreads and could shut the window earlier than usual for late-cycle issuers.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR — TODAY, 13 JULY 2026

LONDON TIME	INDICATOR	CONSENSUS	IMPORTANCE
—	No high-importance Eurozone or UK releases scheduled today		LOW
19:00	US Treasury Statement (June)	n/a	LOW
Context for the rest of the week (not today)			
Tue 14 Jul, 13:30	US CPI (June)	-0.1% m/m / 3.9% y/y headline; core +0.3% m/m / 2.9% y/y	HIGH
Tue 14 Jul	Fed Chair Warsh — House Financial Services testimony	n/a	HIGH
Wed 15 Jul	Fed Chair Warsh — Senate Banking testimony	n/a	HIGH
Wed 15 Jul	US PPI (June)	-0.2% m/m	MEDIUM
Thu 16 Jul	China Q2 GDP	~4.5% y/y (vs 5.0% Q1)	HIGH

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS — TODAY

SK Hynix begins trading under its permanent Nasdaq ticker "SKHY" today, after its provisional "SKHYV" Friday debut.

easyJet takeover battle remains live: board backs Apollo Global Management's 715p/share offer over Castlelake's 690p bid; firm-offer deadline 7 August under the UK Takeover Code.

Vodafone: market continues digesting Friday's Niel/e& 16.2% stake deal.

No confirmed major European or US blue-chip earnings today. Yahoo Finance's calendar lists ~26 global reporters, but no large-cap names confirmed (n/a). No confirmed major AGMs for UK/EU large caps today.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH

easyJet (LSE:EZJ)	Apollo (715p) vs Castlelake (690p) bidding war continues; near 4-year highs after +14% Friday.	Up / volatile
Vodafone (LSE:VOD)	Continued reaction to Niel/e& 16.2% stake purchase at 112.5p; +13% Friday.	Up / volatile
SK Hynix (Nasdaq:SKHY)	First day on permanent ticker after blockbuster $26.5bn debut; Seoul-listed shares hit hard Monday on profit-taking.	Volatile
BP / Shell (LSE:BP, SHEL)	TD Cowen cut price targets (Shell $107, BP $40), both ~20% below mid-year highs; today's oil spike is a near-term offset.	Mixed / volatile
Rio Tinto / Glencore / Anglo American	Sector rotation away from mining toward energy/consumer reported Friday; Rio-Glencore merger talks abandoned Feb 2026.	Down bias
BAE Systems / Rolls-Royce (LSE:BA., RR.)	Defence names slipped Friday on profit-taking after a sustained rally; next catalyst is BAE's H1 results 30 July.	Down / consolidating
IAG (LSE:IAG)	Fuel-cost concerns building into 31 July Q2 results; Ryanair seen as sector's defensive favourite versus IAG/ easyJet-type exposure.	Mixed
A.P. Moller-Maersk	Raised FY26 EBITDA guidance to $8-10bn (from $4.5-7bn) on strong freight rates and cautious Suez transit resumption.	Up
JPMorgan / Citigroup / Wells Fargo / Goldman Sachs / BofA	Pre-positioning ahead of Tue/Wed Q2 earnings; sector seen showing >20% earnings growth for a second straight quarter.	Modest pre-earnings drift
Gold miners	Gold near $4,050-4,100/oz on Gulf risk premium despite today's pullback; watch for sympathy moves on London-listed names.	Mixed / up bias

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh (confirmed 22 May 2026 by a divisive 54-45 Senate vote) delivers his first Humphrey-Hawkins testimony this week — House Tue 14 July, Senate Wed 15 July, ~90 minutes after Tuesday's CPI print.

Market pricing has shifted toward Fed hikes rather than cuts: ~73% probability of a September hike per recent pricing; some banks (BofA, Deutsche Bank) forecast multiple 25bp hikes through year-end on tariffs, AI-demand and Middle East energy costs.

Bank of England's next MPC decision is 30 July 2026 (Bank Rate held at 3.75% through 2026 so far); base case is a hold with a hawkish tilt.

China's June inflation eased to 1.0% y/y (vs 1.1% consensus); PPI 4.1% y/y. Q2 GDP due 16 July, consensus ~4.5% y/y (down from 5.0% in Q1).

CORPORATE

Vodafone: Niel's Vega vehicle to acquire ~16.2% from e& for ~£4.4bn (€5.1bn), pending regulatory approval — makes Niel the largest shareholder.

easyJet bidding war: Apollo (715p) vs Castlelake (690p); board backing Apollo; firm-offer deadline 7 August.

SK Hynix's $26.5bn Nasdaq ADR listing — largest-ever US share sale by a foreign company.

Q2 2026 US earnings season begins this week: major banks Tue/Wed, Netflix Thu 16 July as first major tech reporter; consensus for a second straight quarter of >20% aggregate earnings growth.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

US-Iran Gulf conflict sharply escalated over the weekend: fresh US strikes Saturday, Iranian retaliation across the Gulf including reported strikes reaching Qatar and the UAE; Iran claims the Strait of Hormuz is closed, Washington disputes this.

Maersk cautiously resumed limited Suez Canal/Bab el-Mandeb transits — a tentative signal of improving Red Sea security, not confirmed as full normalisation.

Tariffs remain a live inflation driver cited repeatedly by Fed officials, including Warsh, complicating the rate path; Warsh's contentious confirmation continues to draw political scrutiny of Fed independence ahead of his first testimony.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5

1. Gulf/Iran escalation
Dominant driver of today's risk-off tone and the oil spike; Washington and Tehran give conflicting accounts on whether the Strait of Hormuz is obstructed.

2. Kospi's 18th circuit-breaker of 2026
Tests whether the AI-memory rally (SK Hynix, Samsung) is due a larger correction, with read-through risk to Nasdaq and European chip names.

3. SK Hynix permanent-ticker debut
Will the US listing hold up after Monday's sharp reversal in Seoul.

4. easyJet bid war continues
Apollo 715p vs Castlelake 690p sets the tone for European aviation M&A sentiment.

5. Positioning into Tuesday's CPI
Thin data day likely keeps markets cautious into the week's main catalysts (CPI, bank earnings).

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

1. US CPI (Tue 14 Jul)
Critical for September Fed hike odds after the weekend's oil shock.

2. Fed Chair Warsh's first testimony
House Tue 14 Jul, Senate Wed 15 Jul — first chance for Congress to grill the new hawkish Fed chair.

3. Big US bank earnings kickoff
JPM/WFC/C Tue, GS/BAC/MS Wed — sets tone for a Q2 season expected to show >20% aggregate profit growth.

4. US PPI (Wed 15 Jul)
Second inflation data point of the week alongside CPI.

5. China Q2 GDP & Netflix earnings (Thu 16 Jul)
First major reads on Chinese growth momentum and tech-sector earnings season.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

1. Q2 2026 earnings season
Banks, Netflix, then BAE Systems (30 Jul), IAG (31 Jul), Barratt Redrow trading update (15 Jul) and other large caps.

2. Fed's path to a possible September hike
Warsh's hawkish rhetoric and tariff/oil-driven inflation concerns are the dominant macro narrative for July.

3. BoE MPC decision (30 Jul)
Expected hold at 3.75% with a hawkish tilt amid sticky UK services inflation.

4. US-Iran conflict trajectory
Ceasefire status, Strait of Hormuz shipping security and Suez transit normalisation will keep driving oil and shipping-sector volatility.

5. easyJet takeover resolution
Apollo's 7 August deadline to make a firm offer.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY

Whether Iran/Hormuz headlines escalate further or de-escalate during the European session; follow-through (or reversal) of Asian chip-stock selling at the European open; confirmation of European futures direction once a reliable pre-open print is available; whether oil holds its overnight gains.

1 WEEK

US CPI/PPI prints and Warsh's first Congressional testimony; Q2 US bank earnings kickoff; any firming of the easyJet/Apollo offer; China Q2 GDP release.

1 MONTH

Trajectory of the Gulf conflict and its pass-through to oil and inflation; whether the Fed pivots toward a September hike; full Q2 earnings season, particularly AI/semiconductor capex commentary after Monday's Kospi shock; BoE's 30 July decision; European DCM's summer issuance window closing.

SOURCES

- Reuters, Bloomberg, Financial Times, CNBC, Yahoo Finance
- TradingEconomics, Investing.com, FXStreet, Kitco, Babypips
- Korea JoongAng Daily, Korea Times
- IFR, GlobalCapital, AFME, White & Case, LBBW research
- Official exchanges and statistics agencies: Eurostat, ONS, BLS, Bank of England, US Treasury